



HARRISON WILLIAMS, 16, listens during a discussion in his ethnic studies class at Firebaugh High School in Lynwood. Districts are not required to offer ethnic studies if state funding does not come through.

STATE’S ETHNIC STUDIES MANDATE IN LIMBO

California became a national pioneer four years ago by passing a law to make ethnic studies a high school graduation requirement. But only months before the policy is to take effect, Gov. Gavin Newsom is withholding state funding — delaying the mandate as the course comes under renewed fire.

The pause has left school districts throughout the state in limbo nearly four years after the launch deadline was set. Beginning this fall, students entering 9th grade would have been the first class required to pass a one-semester class at some point during their high school years.

But under the 2021 law, the mandate to reach 5.8 million students does not take effect unless the state provides more money to pay for the course. The funding would cover the cost of materials and the teacher staffing and training that go along with adding a new field of

Newsom budget doesn’t include funding for high school classes that were to start this fall

By Howard Blume

study.

Newsom’s office, which will issue its May revision of next year’s proposed state budget Wednesday amid a tightening financial outlook, did not respond to questions about why he has not included funding for the ethnic studies requirement that he approved, praising it as an avenue to “teach students about the diverse communities that comprise California.”

A spokesperson for the Department of Finance answered on Newsom’s behalf.

“The budget doesn’t include funding that would trigger the ethnic studies graduation requirement,” said H.D. Palmer. As to the reason why, “the short answer is that the state has limited available ongoing resources.”

At the onset, \$50 million in seed money was allocated statewide, but the law stated an [See Curriculum, A8]

L.A. fires may cost all insured homeowners

Carriers ask California to approve surcharges for policyholders across the entire state.

By LAURENCE DARMIENTO

Insurers are seeking to charge homeowners across California for some of the costs of the catastrophic Los Angeles County fires the companies were burdened with when the state’s insurer of last resort needed a bailout.

The California FAIR Plan Assn., with the approval of state Insurance Commissioner Ricardo Lara, assessed its member carriers \$1 billion on Feb. 11 when the plan was swamped with thousands of claims after the Jan. 7 fires in Pacific Palisades, Altadena and Sylmar.

The plan, operated and backstopped by the state’s licensed home insurers, said it has made \$2.75 billion in claims payments as of Friday and expects its costs for

the fires will total \$4 billion, which it could not cover with its limited surplus and reinsurance funds.

Now, under a policy Lara put in place last year that is being challenged in court, insurers are filing applications with the state Department of Insurance seeking to surcharge their policyholders statewide for half the costs of that assessment.

That means even if a person lives hundreds of miles away from the fires, they could be forced to help pay their insurers’ costs of the assessment — on top of annual premiums that have risen hundreds or even thousands of dollars for some homeowners as many insurers have sharply raised rates.

[See Insurance, A11]

17% rate hike OKd for State Farm

Insurance commissioner adopts a judge’s ruling and grants an emergency increase. BUSINESS, A10



A HOUSE burns in Malibu on Jan. 8. At least 10 insurers and affiliates have filed surcharge applications.

Rose, 16 others are reinstated by MLB

All-time hits leader and Black Sox figure Jackson now eligible for the Hall of Fame.

By STEVE HENSON

Pete Rose was posthumously removed from Major League Baseball’s permanently ineligible list Tuesday, making the all-time hits leader eligible for induction into the National Baseball Hall of Fame.

“Shoeless” Joe Jackson, banned after his participation in the 1919 Black Sox scandal, also was reinstated in a sweeping decision by commissioner Rob Manfred that included other deceased players from the list. All are eligible for election to the Hall of Fame.

An MLB statement released Tuesday referred to it

as a “policy decision.”

“This issue has never been formally addressed by Major League Baseball, but an application filed by the family of Pete Rose has made it incumbent upon the Office of the Commissioner to reach a policy decision on this unprecedented issue in the modern era as Mr. Rose is the first person banned after the tenure of commissioner Kenesaw Mountain Landis to die while still on the ineligible list.

“Commissioner Manfred has concluded that MLB’s policy shall be that permanent ineligibility ends upon the passing of the disciplined individual.”

Rose had been exiled from the sport since 1989, after he was found by then-commissioner Bart Giamatti to have been betting on his team’s games while he was manager of the Cincinnati [See Reinstated, A14]



SOLDIERS patrol in Sinaloa state, roiled by cartel violence. Mexican President Claudia Sheinbaum has rejected President Trump’s offer to send U.S. troops.

Could Trump strike cartels?

He says he’d like to. Such a move would present Mexico’s president with a career-defining challenge

By PATRICK J. McDONNELL

MEXICO CITY — She has won acclaim for facing down tariff threats, shunning political bluster and skirting White House provocations — while winning admiration from President Trump.

“A cool head” has been her motto.

But Mexican President Claudia Sheinbaum may soon face her most challenging test — and her response could define bilateral relations for years.

At issue: Trump’s stated determination to deploy U.S. military force against Mexican drug cartels, six of which his administration has designated as foreign terrorist organizations. Trump has vowed to “wage war” on cartels, which, he said, exercise “total control” in Mexico and pose a “grave threat” to U.S. national security.

In response to U.S. pressure, Mexico has cracked down on drug trafficking and illegal immigration, dispatching thousands of troops to its northern frontier and even shipping 29 ac-

cused cartel capos to the United States, skirting Mexican due process guarantees. The Sheinbaum administration has also agreed to expanded U.S. surveillance flights, reportedly including CIA drone forays over Mexican territory.

Still, Sheinbaum rejected Trump’s offer — delivered in a testy telephone call last month — to send the U.S. Army to Mexico. Boots on the ground, she said she told her counterpart, is a red line that Mexico would “never accept,” adding: “Sovereignty is not sold.”

[See Mexico, A4]

Hotel pay raise rattles investors

Some industry leaders say a proposal to boost wages will drive business out of L.A.

By DAVID ZAHNISER AND SUHAUNA HUSSAIN

Perched high above the Cahuenga Pass, the 24-story Hilton Los Angeles Universal City Hotel is positioned to be a prime gathering spot for visitors arriving for the 2028 Summer Olympic and Paralympic Games.

Sun Hill Properties Inc., which manages the 495-room hotel, has already signed a “room block” agreement with the LA28 organizing committee, reserving hundreds of rooms for Olympics fans. The City Council recently approved a plan to let the Hilton add a second, 18-story tower, which would open just in time for the Olympics.

Now, the future of the \$250-million expansion is in doubt. On Wednesday, the Los Angeles City Council is set to vote on a requirement that hotels with 60 or more rooms pay their workers at least \$30 per hour by 2028, along with a new \$8.35 per hour healthcare payment.

[See Hotel, A14]

Trump, Saudis reach weapons deal

White House says pact is part of the biggest economic agreement between the two nations. WORLD, A3

New sentence for Menendezes

A judge says he will resentence the brothers, making them eligible for parole. CALIFORNIA, B1

Weather
Sunny and warmer.
L.A. Basin: 74/55. B6

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Actor calls out Meta’s CEO

Jamie Lee Curtis takes Mark Zuckerberg to task over fake AI-made endorsement on Instagram. BUSINESS, A10



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